Claude Code Cheat Sheet

01 Start a session (in your terminal)

`claude`	Start an interactive session in the current folder.
`claude "task"`	Start a session with a first prompt already sent.
`claude -c`	Continue the most recent conversation in this folder.
`claude -r`	Pick an earlier session from a list. Add a name or ID to jump straight to it.
`claude -p "task"`	Print mode: answer once and exit. Good for scripts and pipes.
`--model opus`	Choose the model for this session.
`--permission-mode`	Start in a given mode: manual, acceptEdits, plan, auto, dontAsk, bypassPermissions.
`--add-dir path`	Let Claude read and edit a second folder too.
`claude update`	Install the latest version.
`claude doctor`	Check the install, PATH, and settings for problems.

02 Talk to Claude

`@file`	Point Claude at a file. Type @ and a few letters to autocomplete the path.
`Ctrl+V`	Paste a screenshot from the clipboard. You can also drag an image into the window. On Windows, try Alt+V if Ctrl+V doesn't work.
`! command`	Run a shell command yourself. The output goes into the conversation.
`/`	Open the list of commands and skills. Keep typing to filter it.
`\ + Enter`	New line without sending. Shift+Enter works in most terminals (run /terminal-setup if it doesn't). Ctrl+J works everywhere.
`Ctrl+G`	Write the prompt in your text editor, then save and close it to send.
`Ctrl+R`	Search the prompts you've sent before.
`Ctrl+S`	Set the current prompt aside. Press again to bring it back.

03 Stop, undo, and look around

`Esc`	Stop Claude mid-step. Work done so far is kept, so you can redirect it.
`Esc Esc`	With an empty prompt, opens the rewind menu to go back to an earlier point. With text typed, clears the prompt.
`Ctrl+C`	Cancel the current step. Press twice on an empty prompt to quit.
`Ctrl+O`	Show the full transcript, including every tool call.
`Ctrl+T`	Show or hide Claude's to-do list for the task.
`Ctrl+B`	Send a long-running command to the background so you can keep working.
`Option+P`	Switch model without losing your prompt (Alt+P on Windows and Linux).
`Ctrl+D`	Exit Claude Code.

04 Permission modes: Shift+Tab

`Manual`	The default. Claude asks before every edit and command.
`Accept edits`	File edits go through without asking. Commands still ask.
`Plan`	Claude reads and plans but changes nothing. Approve the plan to start work.
`Auto`	A safety classifier approves routine steps and blocks risky ones. Fewer prompts than Manual.
`Bypass`	No checks at all. Shows up only if you turned it on at launch, as the `clauded` alias in the setup guide does. Use it in a throwaway folder or VM, never on real systems.

Each press of **Shift+Tab** moves one step down this list. The current mode shows under the prompt.

05 Set up auto mode

`Shift+Tab`	Pick Auto for this session.
`--permission-mode auto`	Start a session in auto mode from the command line.
`"defaultMode": "auto"`	Make it your default. Put it under `permissions` in `~/.claude/settings.json`. Project settings files ignore it.
`claude auto-mode config`	Print the auto mode rules now in effect.
`claude auto-mode defaults`	Print the built-in allow and deny rules.
`claude auto-mode reset`	Remove your custom rules and go back to the defaults.

Recent versions start in auto mode by default. It needs a current model, and your admin can turn it off.

Habits that save you

Start in **Plan** mode for anything bigger than a small edit. Read the plan before you approve it.
Run **/clear** when you switch tasks. Old context costs tokens and confuses the next job.
Press **Esc** the moment Claude heads the wrong way. Don't wait for it to finish.
Run **/diff** before you commit, and read every line.

Plans and pricing

Claude Code needs a paid plan or API credits. **/usage** shows how much of your plan's limit you've used. Large models like Opus use up the limit faster than Sonnet or Haiku.

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06 Set up a project

`/init`	Read the project and write a `CLAUDE.md` file describing it. Run it once per project. Claude reads that file at the start of every session.
`/memory`	Edit `CLAUDE.md` and turn auto memory on or off. Or just say "remember that...".
`/permissions`	List and edit the rules that allow, ask about, or deny tools and commands.
`/config`	Open settings: theme, editor mode (including vim keys), notifications, and more.
`/add-dir`	Give Claude access to another folder during this session.
`/login /logout`	Sign in or out, or switch to a different account.

07 Model and speed

`/model`	Switch model. With no name, opens a picker. Your choice becomes the default.
`/effort`	Set how hard the model thinks: low, medium, high, and up. Lower is faster and cheaper.
`/fast`	Turn fast mode on or off. Same model, quicker answers, higher cost.
`/usage`	Session cost, plan limits, and activity. `/cost` and `/stats` open the same screen.
`/status`	Version, model, account, and connection status.

08 Manage the conversation

`/context`	See how full the context window is, broken down by what's using it.
`/compact`	Summarize the conversation so far to free up room, then keep working. Add a focus: `/compact keep the test results`.
`/clear`	Start fresh with an empty conversation. Use it between unrelated tasks.
`/resume`	Go back to an earlier session. Opens a picker if you don't name one.
`/rewind`	Go back to an earlier point and undo the code changes since then. Same as Esc Esc.
`/btw`	Ask a quick side question that doesn't get added to the conversation.
`/export`	Save the conversation to a file or copy it to the clipboard.
`/exit`	Leave Claude Code.

09 Review the work

`/diff`	Show every change in the working tree, including Claude's edits.
`/code-review`	Review your changes or a pull request for bugs. Add a level (low to max) and `--fix` to apply fixes, or `--comment` to post on the PR. `/review` does the same thing.
`/security-review`	Check this branch's changes for security problems. Needs a git remote named origin.

10 Connect and extend

`/mcp`	List MCP servers (connections to outside tools and data), sign in to them, reconnect, or turn them off.
`claude mcp add`	Add a server from the terminal. Remote: `claude mcp add --transport http name url`. Local: `claude mcp add name -- command`.
`claude mcp list`	Show the servers you've configured.
`/plugin`	Browse, install, and manage plugins, which bundle skills, agents, hooks, and MCP servers.
`/agents`	Create and manage subagents, specialist helpers with their own instructions.
`/hooks`	See the hooks that run your scripts automatically on events like an edit or a command.
`/schedule`	Create and manage tasks that run on a schedule in the cloud. Also called /routines.
`/loop`	Repeat a prompt on a timer while the session is open. `/loop 10m check the build`.
`/statusline`	Set up the status line shown under the prompt.

Where things live

`CLAUDE.md` in the project: instructions for this repo, shared with your team.
`~/.claude/CLAUDE.md`: your personal instructions for every project.
`~/.claude/settings.json`: your settings, permissions, and default mode.
`.claude/settings.json`: project settings committed to the repo.